

Tackling the Red Terror

OCTOBER 26, 2009

The Centre unveils a new calibrated, two-pronged strategy to neutralise the Maoist threat with the biggest-ever offensive using crack forces. Can it succeed?



“ Coordination between the Centre and the concerned state is vital to fight the Maoists. In such a scenario, intelligence sharing among the Maoist-affected states should be ensured. ”

MEGHANA M., *United Kingdom*

Red Alert

It is at last a matter of great relief to hear about the home minister's acceptance of the Maoist challenge ("Tackling the Red Terror", October 26). Even if the Government is successful in eliminating this menace, the danger of rebirth lies in some college and university campuses where the Maoist ideology is discussed in the open and support garnered in the name of the right to have student unions. The Government will do well to keep an eye on the campuses which have a history of breeding such misguided ideologues.

INDRANIL SARKAR, *Kolkata*

Any number of appeals is not going to make the Naxalites see reason. Neither do they have faith in our Constitution nor in democratic institutions.



Chinese Checker

It was good to read about China's transformation post-1978 with the proper mix of a cultural-economic thrust boiled in the Westernised industrial model ("Anatomy of a Miracle", October 26). It will be appropriate to give more credit to China's "Confucian tradition of meritocracy" which the Chinese leadership has adopted for good governance. It is in stark contrast to our leadership's approach of grooming dynastic rule at every level of governance in the country.

H.C. PANDEY, *Delhi*

China's objection to Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's visit to Arunachal Pradesh and its participation in a project in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir calls for stern action by India. Jammu and Kashmir and Arunachal Pradesh are integral parts of India and by creating tension in these areas, China is spoiling its relations with us.

M. KUMAR, *via www.indiatoday.in*

The concern of the Government for the Maoists and its appeals do not speak of any resolution to deal with the problems effectively. On the contrary, it is exactly on the line of Indo-Pak relations. While the Government should continue its approach of talks with terrorists, at the same time it should make sure that there is no let-up in the war against such groups. It is high time that dilly-dallying as a policy should be given up.

K.S. JAYATHEERTHA, *Bangalore*

Your cover story has very analytically, factually and sensitively taken the readers on an enlightening journey through the Red Corridor. But the big question remains: why are the poor, and deprived people attracted to the Maoists? I strongly feel that unless the Indian nation strives to

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